the local moles. But some locals strongly believed that as far as human intelligence for drone attacks was concerned, it was provided by the Pakistan intelligence and the drone campaign was continuing successfully due to this collaboration.

This view carried weight. In 2004, three years before the formation of TTP, known Al Qaeda supporter Nek Mohammad and four other tribal militants were killed in a missile attack on a village in Wana, South Waziristan Agency. Witnesses stated that a spy drone was seen flying overheard minutes before the missile attack. There were also reports that Nek Mohammad was speaking on a satellite phone when the missile struck, fuelling speculation that he might have been hit by a guided missile. The precision with which the missile landed right in the middle of the courtyard where Nek Mohammad and his colleagues were sitting lent credence to the theory (Dawn, 2004).

However, as the Inter-Services Public Relations (ISPR) Director General Major General Shaukat Sultan commented:

> We have various means and a full array of weapons at our disposal. We have artillery that can fire with precision and we have helicopters with night vision capability which can fire guided missiles. But I am not going to give out operational secrets on how he was killed.[5]

This statement indicated that if at all it was the US drone missile that killed Nek Muhammad, it was fired with the consent of the Pakistan Army or it was at least in its knowledge.

The reaction of the government of Pakistan on the drone campaign had been unsteady. It only reacted with anger (mock probably) over it whenever the public pressure was too high. It tried to douse it with condemnation of this campaign. It never seriously threatened to cut off diplomatic relations or mulled over any other serious steps of the same nature to pressurise the US to stop it as it did after the NATO attack on the Salala checkposts.

No official rebuttal came after Bob Woodward's story that former CIA Director Mike Hayden visited Zardari in the InterContinental New York Barclay Hotel, where Zardari and Ambassador Husain Haqqani waited for him. Zardari said, 'Kill the seniors.' 'Collateral damage worries you Americans. It does not worry me.' Reporting this startling